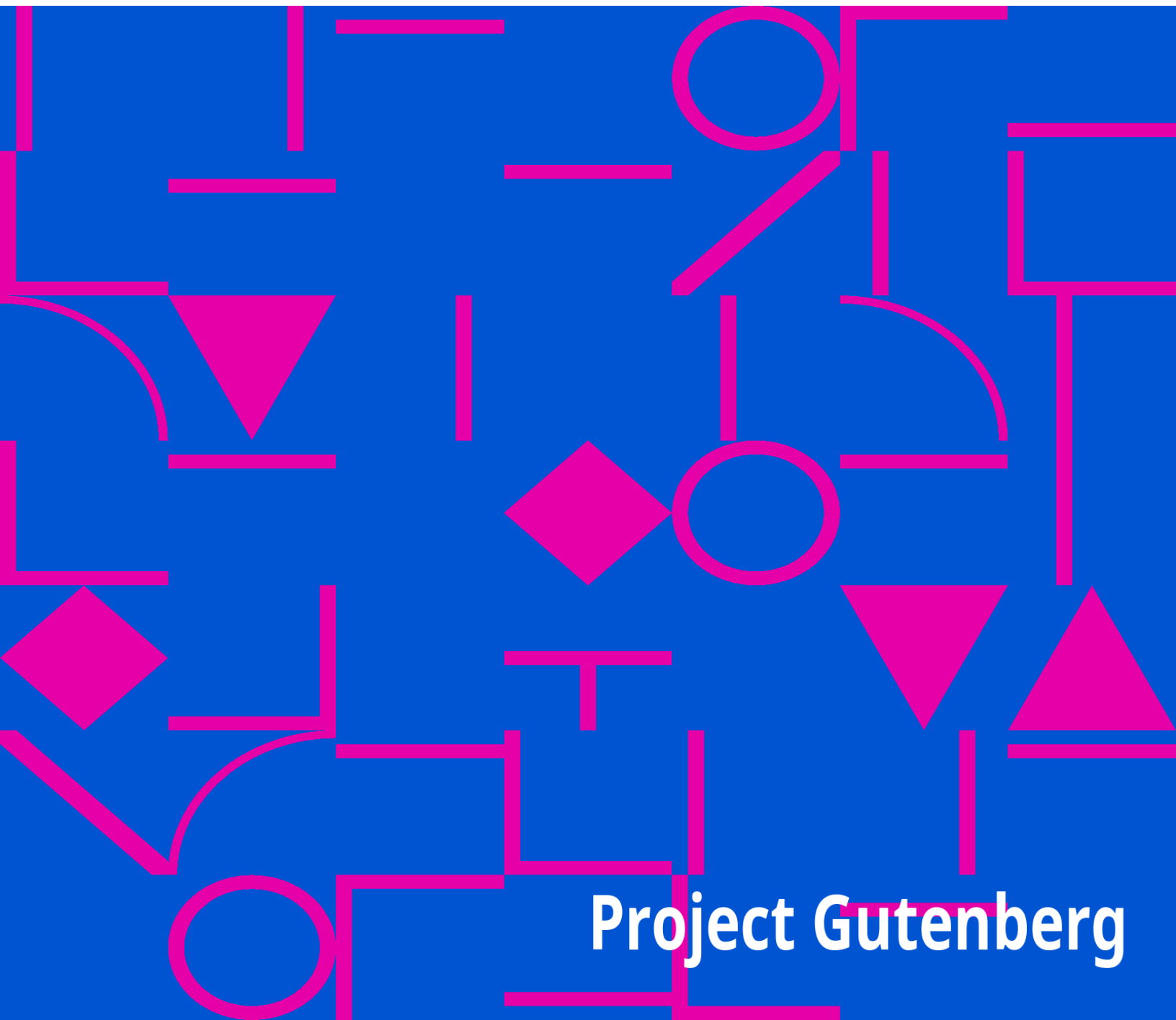


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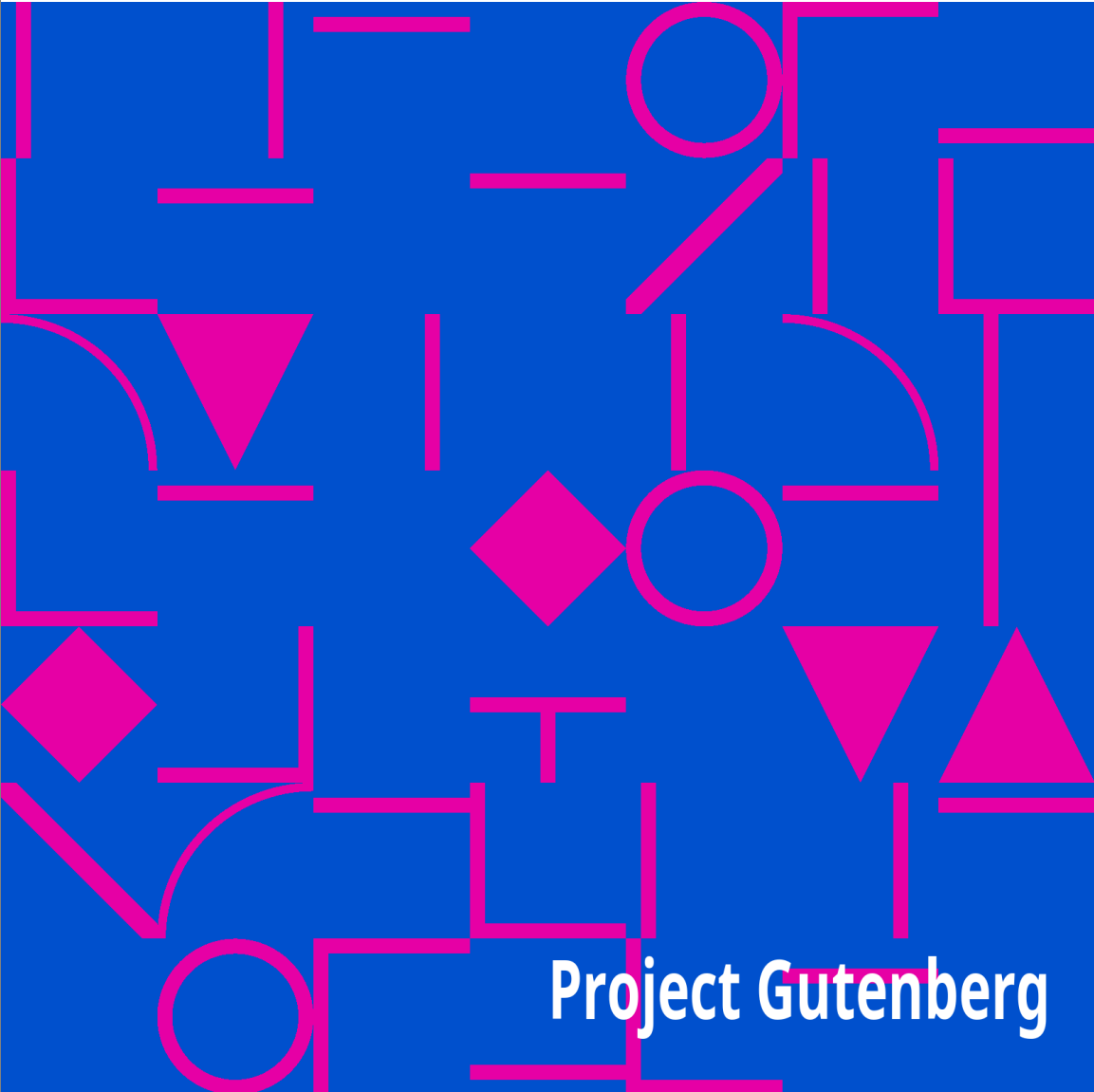
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Title: The World English Bible (WEB): 2 Samuel

Author: Anonymous

Release date: June 1, 2005 [eBook #8237]

Most recently updated: December 26, 2020

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/8237

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE WORLD
ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB): 2 SAMUEL ***

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Book 10 2 Samuel 001:001 It happened after the death of Saul, when David was returned from the slaughter of the Amalekites, and David had abode two days in Ziklag; 001:002 it happened on the third day, that behold, a man came out of the camp from Saul, with his clothes torn, and earth on his head: and so it was, when he came to David, that he fell to the earth, and did obeisance. 001:003 David said

**to him, From whence come you?
He said to him, Out of the camp of
Israel am I escaped. 001:004 David
said to him, How went the matter?
Please tell me. He answered, The
people are fled from the battle, and
many of the people also are fallen
and dead; and Saul and Jonathan
his son are dead also. 001:005
David said to the young man who
told him, How know you that Saul
and Jonathan his son are dead?
001:006 The young man who told
him said, As I happened by chance
on Mount Gilboa, behold, Saul was
leaning on his spear; and behold,
the chariots and the horsemen
followed hard after him. 001:007**

**When he looked behind him, he
saw me, and called to me. I
answered, Here am I. 001:008 He
said to me, Who are you? I
answered him, I am an Amalekite.
001:009 He said to me, Stand, I
pray you, beside me, and kill me;
for anguish has taken hold of me,
because my life is yet whole in me.
001:010 So I stood beside him, and
killed him, because I was sure that
he could not live after that he was
fallen: and I took the crown that
was on his head, and the bracelet
that was on his arm, and have
brought them here to my lord.
001:011 Then David took hold on
his clothes, and tore them; and**

likewise all the men who were with him: 001:012 and they mourned, and wept, and fasted until even, for Saul, and for Jonathan his son, and for the people of Yahweh, and for the house of Israel; because they were fallen by the sword. 001:013 David said to the young man who told him, Whence are you? He answered, I am the son of a foreigner, an Amalekite. 001:014 David said to him, How were you not afraid to put forth your hand to destroy Yahweh's anointed? 001:015 David called one of the young men, and said, Go near, and fall on him. He struck him, so that he died. 001:016 David said to him,

**Your blood be on your head; for
your mouth has testified against
you, saying, I have slain Yahweh's
anointed. 001:017 David lamented
with this lamentation over Saul and
over Jonathan his son 001:018 (and
he bade them teach the children of
Judah [the song of] the bow:
behold, it is written in the book of
Jashar): 001:019 Your glory, Israel,
is slain on your high places! How
the mighty have fallen! 001:020
Don't tell it in Gath. Don't publish
it in the streets of Ashkelon, lest the
daughters of the Philistines rejoice,
lest the daughters of the
uncircumcised triumph. 001:021
You mountains of Gilboa, let there**

**be no dew nor rain on you, neither
fields of offerings; For there the
shield of the mighty was vilely cast
away, The shield of Saul was not
anointed with oil. 001:022 From the
blood of the slain, from the fat of
the mighty, Jonathan's bow didn't
turn back. Saul's sword didn't
return empty. 001:023 Saul and
Jonathan were lovely and pleasant
in their lives. In their death, they
were not divided. They were swifter
than eagles. They were stronger
than lions. 001:024 You daughters
of Israel, weep over Saul, who
clothed you in scarlet delicately,
who put ornaments of gold on your
clothing. 001:025 How are the**

mighty fallen in the midst of the battle! Jonathan is slain on your high places. 001:026 I am distressed for you, my brother Jonathan. You have been very pleasant to me. Your love to me was wonderful, passing the love of women. 001:027 How are the mighty fallen, and the weapons of war perished! 002:001 It happened after this, that David inquired of Yahweh, saying, Shall I go up into any of the cities of Judah? Yahweh said to him, Go up. David said, Where shall I go up? He said, To Hebron. 002:002 So David went up there, and his two wives also, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of

Nabal the Carmelite. 002:003 His men who were with him did David bring up, every man with his household: and they lived in the cities of Hebron. 002:004 The men of Judah came, and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah. They told David, saying, The men of Jabesh Gilead were those who buried Saul. 002:005 David sent messengers to the men of Jabesh Gilead, and said to them, Blessed be you of Yahweh, that you have shown this kindness to your lord, even to Saul, and have buried him. 002:006 Now Yahweh show loving kindness and truth to you: and I also will requite you this

kindness, because you have done this thing. 002:007 Now therefore let your hands be strong, and be you valiant; for Saul your lord is dead, and also the house of Judah have anointed me king over them. 002:008 Now Abner the son of Ner, captain of Saul's army, had taken Ishbosheth the son of Saul, and brought him over to Mahanaim; 002:009 and he made him king over Gilead, and over the Ashurites, and over Jezreel, and over Ephraim, and over Benjamin, and over all Israel. 002:010 Ishbosheth, Saul's son, was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel, and he reigned two years. But the house of

Judah followed David. 002:011 The time that David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months. 002:012

Abner the son of Ner, and the servants of Ishbosheth the son of Saul, went out from Mahanaim to Gibeon. 002:013 Joab the son of Zeruiah, and the servants of David, went out, and met them by the pool of Gibeon; and they sat down, the one on the one side of the pool, and the other on the other side of the pool. 002:014 Abner said to Joab, Please let the young men arise and play before us. Joab said, Let them arise. 002:015 Then they arose and went over by number: twelve for

Benjamin, and for Ishbosheth the son of Saul, and twelve of the servants of David. 002:016 They caught everyone his fellow by the head, and [thrust] his sword in his fellow's side; so they fell down together: therefore that place was called Helkath Hazzurim, which is in Gibeon. 002:017 The battle was very severe that day: and Abner was beaten, and the men of Israel, before the servants of David. 002:018 The three sons of Zeruiah were there, Joab, and Abishai, and Asahel: and Asahel was as light of foot as a wild gazelle. 002:019 Asahel pursued after Abner; and in going he didn't turn to the right

hand nor to the left from following Abner. 002:020 Then Abner looked behind him, and said, Is it you, Asahel? He answered, It is I.

002:021 Abner said to him, Turn you aside to your right hand or to your left, and lay you hold on one of the young men, and take you his armor. But Asahel would not turn aside from following him. 002:022 Abner said again to Asahel, Turn you aside from following me: why should I strike you to the ground? how then should I hold up my face to Joab your brother? 002:023 However he refused to turn aside: therefore Abner with the hinder end of the spear struck him in the

body, so that the spear came out behind him; and he fell down there, and died in the same place: and it happened, that as many as came to the place where Asahel fell down and died stood still. 002:024 But Joab and Abishai pursued after Abner: and the sun went down when they were come to the hill of Ammah, that lies before Giah by the way of the wilderness of Gibeon. 002:025 The children of Benjamin gathered themselves together after Abner, and became one band, and stood on the top of a hill. 002:026 Then Abner called to Joab, and said, "Shall the sword devour forever? Don't you know

that it will be bitterness in the latter end? How long shall it be then, before you bid the people return from following their brothers?" 002:027 Joab said, As God lives, if you had not spoken, surely then in the morning the people had gone away, nor followed everyone his brother. 002:028 So Joab blew the trumpet; and all the people stood still, and pursued after Israel no more, neither fought they any more. 002:029 Abner and his men went all that night through the Arabah; and they passed over the Jordan, and went through all Bithron, and came to Mahanaim. 002:030 Joab returned from

following Abner: and when he had gathered all the people together, there lacked of David's servants nineteen men and Asahel. 002:031 But the servants of David had struck of Benjamin, and of Abner's men, [so that] three hundred sixty men died. 002:032 They took up Asahel, and buried him in the tomb of his father, which was in Bethlehem. Joab and his men went all night, and the day broke on them at Hebron. 003:001 Now there was long war between the house of Saul and the house of David: and David grew stronger and stronger, but the house of Saul grew weaker and weaker. 003:002 To David were

sons born in Hebron: and his firstborn was Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess; 003:003 and his second, Chileab, of Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite; and the third, Absalom the son of Maacah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur; 003:004 and the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith; and the fifth, Shephatiah the son of Abital; 003:005 and the sixth, Ithream, of Eglah, David's wife. These were born to David in Hebron. 003:006 It happened, while there was war between the house of Saul and the house of David, that Abner made himself strong in the house of Saul. 003:007 Now Saul

had a concubine, whose name was Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah: and [Ishbosheth] said to Abner, Why have you gone in to my father's concubine? 003:008 Then was Abner very angry for the words of Ishbosheth, and said, Am I a dog's head that belongs to Judah? This day do I show kindness to the house of Saul your father, to his brothers, and to his friends, and have not delivered you into the hand of David; and yet you charge me this day with a fault concerning this woman. 003:009 God do so to Abner, and more also, if, as Yahweh has sworn to David, I don't do even so to him; 003:010 to transfer the

**kingdom from the house of Saul,
and to set up the throne of David
over Israel and over Judah, from
Dan even to Beersheba. 003:011 He
could not answer Abner another
word, because he feared him.**

**003:012 Abner sent messengers to
David on his behalf, saying, Whose
is the land? saying [also], Make
your league with me, and behold,
my hand shall be with you, to bring
about all Israel to you. 003:013 He
said, Well; I will make a league
with you; but one thing I require of
you: that is, you shall not see my
face, except you first bring Michal,
Saul's daughter, when you come to
see my face. 003:014 David sent**

messengers to Ishbosheth, Saul's son, saying, Deliver me my wife Michal, whom I pledged to be married to me for one hundred foreskins of the Philistines. 003:015 Ishbosheth sent, and took her from her husband, even from Paltiel the son of Laish. 003:016 Her husband went with her, weeping as he went, and followed her to Bahurim. Then said Abner to him, Go, return: and he returned. 003:017 Abner had communication with the elders of Israel, saying, In times past you sought for David to be king over you: 003:018 now then do it; for Yahweh has spoken of David, saying, By the hand of my servant

David I will save my people Israel out of the hand of the Philistines, and out of the hand of all their enemies. 003:019 Abner also spoke in the ears of Benjamin: and Abner went also to speak in the ears of David in Hebron all that seemed good to Israel, and to the whole house of Benjamin. 003:020 So Abner came to David to Hebron, and twenty men with him. David made Abner and the men who were with him a feast. 003:021 Abner said to David, I will arise and go, and will gather all Israel to my lord the king, that they may make a covenant with you, and that you may reign over all that your soul

**desires. David sent Abner away;
and he went in peace. 003:022
Behold, the servants of David and
Joab came from a foray, and
brought in a great spoil with them:
but Abner was not with David in
Hebron; for he had sent him away,
and he was gone in peace. 003:023
When Joab and all the army who
was with him had come, they told
Joab, saying, Abner the son of Ner
came to the king, and he has sent
him away, and he is gone in peace.
003:024 Then Joab came to the
king, and said, What have you
done? behold, Abner came to you;
why is it that you have sent him
away, and he is quite gone? 003:025**

**You know Abner the son of Ner,
that he came to deceive you, and to
know your going out and your
coming in, and to know all that you
do. 003:026 When Joab was come
out from David, he sent messengers
after Abner, and they brought him
back from the well of Sirah: but
David didn't know it. 003:027
When Abner was returned to
Hebron, Joab took him aside into
the midst of the gate to speak with
him quietly, and struck him there
in the body, so that he died, for the
blood of Asahel his brother.
003:028 Afterward, when David
heard it, he said, I and my kingdom
are guiltless before Yahweh forever**

**of the blood of Abner the son of
Ner: 003:029 let it fall on the head
of Joab, and on all his father's
house; and let there not fail from
the house of Joab one who has an
issue, or who is a leper, or who
leans on a staff, or who falls by the
sword, or who lacks bread. 003:030
So Joab and Abishai his brother
killed Abner, because he had killed
their brother Asahel at Gibeon in
the battle. 003:031 David said to
Joab, and to all the people who
were with him, Tear your clothes,
and gird you with sackcloth, and
mourn before Abner. King David
followed the bier. 003:032 They
buried Abner in Hebron: and the**

king lifted up his voice, and wept at the grave of Abner; and all the people wept. 003:033 The king lamented for Abner, and said, Should Abner die as a fool dies? 003:034 Your hands were not bound, nor your feet put into fetters. As a man falls before the children of iniquity, so you fell. All the people wept again over him. 003:035 All the people came to cause David to eat bread while it was yet day; but David swore, saying, God do so to me, and more also, if I taste bread, or anything else, until the sun be down. 003:036 All the people took notice of it, and it pleased them; as whatever the

king did pleased all the people.

003:037 So all the people and all Israel understood that day that it was not of the king to kill Abner the son of Ner. 003:038 The king said to his servants, "Don't you know that there a prince and a great man has fallen this day in Israel? 003:039 I am this day weak, though anointed king; and these men the sons of Zeruiah are too hard for me. May Yahweh reward the evil-doer according to his wickedness."

004:001 When [Ishbosheth], Saul's son, heard that Abner was dead in Hebron, his hands became feeble, and all the Israelites were troubled.

004:002 [Ishbosheth], Saul's son,

[had] two men who were captains of bands: the name of the one was Baanah, and the name of the other Rechab, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, of the children of Benjamin (for Beeroth also is reckoned to Benjamin: 004:003 and the Beerothites fled to Gittaim, and have lived as foreigners there until this day). 004:004 Now Jonathan, Saul's son, had a son who was lame of his feet. He was five years old when the news came of Saul and Jonathan out of Jezreel; and his nurse took him up, and fled: and it happened, as she made haste to flee, that he fell, and became lame. His name was Mephibosheth.

004:005 The sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, Rechab and Baanah, went, and came about the heat of the day to the house of Ishbosheth, as he took his rest at noon. 004:006 They came there into the midst of the house, as though they would have fetched wheat; and they struck him in the body: and Rechab and Baanah his brother escaped. 004:007 Now when they came into the house, as he lay on his bed in his bedchamber, they struck him, and killed him, and beheaded him, and took his head, and went by the way of the Arabah all night. 004:008 They brought the head of Ishbosheth to David to

**Hebron, and said to the king,
Behold, the head of Ishbosheth, the
son of Saul, your enemy, who
sought your life; and Yahweh has
avenged my lord the king this day
of Saul, and of his seed. 004:009**

**David answered Rechab and
Baanah his brother, the sons of
Rimmon the Beerothite, and said to
them, As Yahweh lives, who has
redeemed my soul out of all
adversity, 004:010 when one told
me, saying, Behold, Saul is dead,
thinking to have brought good
news, I took hold of him, and killed
him in Ziklag, which was the
reward I gave him for his news.
004:011 How much more, when**

wicked men have slain a righteous person in his own house on his bed, shall I not now require his blood of your hand, and take you away from the earth? 004:012 David

commanded his young men, and they killed them, and cut off their hands and their feet, and hanged them up beside the pool in Hebron.

But they took the head of Ishbosheth, and buried it in the grave of Abner in Hebron. 005:001 Then came all the tribes of Israel to David to Hebron, and spoke, saying, Behold, we are your bone and your flesh. 005:002 In times past, when Saul was king over us, it was you who led out and brought in

Israel: and Yahweh said to you, You shall be shepherd of my people Israel, and you shall be prince over Israel. 005:003 So all the elders of Israel came to the king to Hebron; and king David made a covenant with them in Hebron before Yahweh: and they anointed David king over Israel. 005:004 David was thirty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years. 005:005 In Hebron he reigned over Judah seven years and six months; and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty-three years over all Israel and Judah. 005:006 The king and his men went to Jerusalem against the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the

land, who spoke to David, saying,
Except you take away the blind and
the lame, you shall not come in
here; thinking, David can't come in
here. 005:007 Nevertheless David
took the stronghold of Zion; the
same is the city of David. 005:008
David said on that day, Whoever
strikes the Jebusites, let him get up
to the watercourse, and [strike] the
lame and the blind, who are hated
of David's soul. Therefore they say,
There are the blind and the lame;
he can't come into the house.
005:009 David lived in the
stronghold, and called it the city of
David. David built round about
from Millo and inward. 005:010

David grew greater and greater; for Yahweh, the God of Armies, was with him. 005:011 Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar trees, and carpenters, and masons; and they built David a house. 005:012 David perceived that Yahweh had established him king over Israel, and that he had exalted his kingdom for his people Israel's sake. 005:013 David took him more concubines and wives out of Jerusalem, after he was come from Hebron; and there were yet sons and daughters born to David. 005:014 These are the names of those who were born to him in Jerusalem: Shammua, and Shobab,

**and Nathan, and Solomon, 005:015
and Ibhar, and Elishua, and
Nepheg, and Japhia, 005:016 and
Elishama, and Eliada, and
Eliphelet. 005:017 When the
Philistines heard that they had
anointed David king over Israel, all
the Philistines went up to seek
David; and David heard of it, and
went down to the stronghold.
005:018 Now the Philistines had
come and spread themselves in the
valley of Rephaim. 005:019 David
inquired of Yahweh, saying, Shall I
go up against the Philistines? will
you deliver them into my hand?
Yahweh said to David, Go up; for I
will certainly deliver the Philistines**

into your hand. 005:020 David came to Baal Perazim, and David struck them there; and he said, Yahweh has broken my enemies before me, like the breach of waters. Therefore he called the name of that place Baal Perazim. 005:021 They left their images there; and David and his men took them away. 005:022 The Philistines came up yet again, and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim. 005:023 When David inquired of Yahweh, he said, You shall not go up: make a circuit behind them, and come on them over against the mulberry trees. 005:024 It shall be, when you hear

**the sound of marching in the tops
of the mulberry trees, that then you
shall bestir yourself; for then is
Yahweh gone out before you to
strike the army of the Philistines.**

**005:025 David did so, as Yahweh
commanded him, and struck the
Philistines from Geba until you
come to Gezer. 006:001 David again
gathered together all the chosen
men of Israel, thirty thousand.**

**006:002 David arose, and went with
all the people who were with him,
from Baale Judah, to bring up
from there the ark of God, which is
called by the Name, even the name
of Yahweh of Armies who sits
[above] the cherubim. 006:003**

They set the ark of God on a new cart, and brought it out of the house of Abinadab that was in the hill: and Uzzah and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, drove the new cart. 006:004 They brought it out of the house of Abinadab, which was in the hill, with the ark of God: and Ahio went before the ark. 006:005 David and all the house of Israel played before Yahweh with all manner of [instruments made of] fir wood, and with harps, and with stringed instruments, and with tambourines, and with castanets, and with cymbals. 006:006 When they came to the threshing floor of Nacon, Uzzah put forth [his hand]

**to the ark of God, and took hold of
it; for the oxen stumbled. 006:007
The anger of Yahweh was kindled
against Uzzah; and God struck him
there for his error; and there he
died by the ark of God. 006:008
David was displeased, because
Yahweh had broken forth on
Uzzah; and he called that place
Perez Uzzah, to this day. 006:009
David was afraid of Yahweh that
day; and he said, How shall the ark
of Yahweh come to me? 006:010 So
David would not remove the ark of
Yahweh to him into the city of
David; but David carried it aside
into the house of Obed-Edom the
Gittite. 006:011 The ark of Yahweh**

remained in the house of Obed-Edom the Gittite three months: and Yahweh blessed Obed-Edom, and all his house. 006:012 It was told king David, saying, Yahweh has blessed the house of Obed-Edom, and all that pertains to him, because of the ark of God. David went and brought up the ark of God from the house of Obed-Edom into the city of David with joy.

006:013 It was so, that, when those who bore the ark of Yahweh had gone six paces, he sacrificed an ox and a fattened calf. 006:014 David danced before Yahweh with all his might; and David was girded with a linen ephod. 006:015 So David

and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of Yahweh with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet. 006:016 It was so, as the ark of Yahweh came into the city of David, that Michal the daughter of Saul looked out at the window, and saw king David leaping and dancing before Yahweh; and she despised him in her heart. 006:017 They brought in the ark of Yahweh, and set it in its place, in the midst of the tent that David had pitched for it; and David offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before Yahweh. 006:018 When David had made an end of offering the burnt offering and the peace offerings, he

**blessed the people in the name of
Yahweh of Armies. 006:019 He
dealt among all the people, even
among the whole multitude of
Israel, both to men and women, to
everyone a cake of bread, and a
portion [of flesh], and a cake of
raisins. So all the people departed
everyone to his house. 006:020
Then David returned to bless his
household. Michal the daughter of
Saul came out to meet David, and
said, How glorious was the king of
Israel today, who uncovered
himself today in the eyes of the
handmaids of his servants, as one
of the vain fellows shamelessly
uncovers himself! 006:021 David**

said to Michal, [It was] before
Yahweh, who chose me above your
father, and above all his house, to
appoint me prince over the people
of Yahweh, over Israel: therefore
will I play before Yahweh. 006:022
I will be yet more vile than this,
and will be base in my own sight:
but of the handmaids of whom you
have spoken, they shall honor me.
006:023 Michal the daughter of
Saul had no child to the day of her
death. 007:001 It happened, when
the king lived in his house, and
Yahweh had given him rest from all
his enemies round about, 007:002
that the king said to Nathan the
prophet, See now, I dwell in a house

of cedar, but the ark of God dwells within curtains. 007:003 Nathan said to the king, Go, do all that is in your heart; for Yahweh is with you. 007:004 It happened the same night, that the word of Yahweh came to Nathan, saying, 007:005 Go and tell my servant David, Thus says Yahweh, Shall you build me a house for me to dwell in? 007:006 for I have not lived in a house since the day that I brought up the children of Israel out of Egypt, even to this day, but have moved around in a tent and in a tabernacle. 007:007 In all places in which I have walked with all the children of Israel, spoke I a word

**with any of the tribes of Israel,
whom I commanded to be shepherd
of my people Israel, saying, Why
have you not built me a house of
cedar? 007:008 Now therefore thus
shall you tell my servant David,
Thus says Yahweh of Armies, I took
you from the sheep pen, from
following the sheep, that you
should be prince over my people,
over Israel; 007:009 and I have
been with you wherever you went,
and have cut off all your enemies
from before you; and I will make
you a great name, like the name of
the great ones who are in the earth.
007:010 I will appoint a place for
my people Israel, and will plant**

them, that they may dwell in their own place, and be moved no more; neither shall the children of wickedness afflict them any more, as at the first, 007:011 and [as] from the day that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel; and I will cause you to rest from all your enemies. Moreover Yahweh tells you that Yahweh will make you a house. 007:012 When your days are fulfilled, and you shall sleep with your fathers, I will set up your seed after you, who shall proceed out of your bowels, and I will establish his kingdom. 007:013 He shall build a house for my name, and I will establish the

throne of his kingdom forever.

007:014 I will be his father, and he shall be my son: if he commit iniquity, I will chasten him with the rod of men, and with the stripes of the children of men; 007:015 but my loving kindness shall not depart from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I put away before you.

007:016 Your house and your kingdom shall be made sure for ever before you: your throne shall be established forever. 007:017

According to all these words, and according to all this vision, so did Nathan speak to David. 007:018

Then David the king went in, and sat before Yahweh; and he said,

Who am I, Lord Yahweh, and what is my house, that you have brought me thus far? 007:019 This was yet a small thing in your eyes, Lord Yahweh; but you have spoken also of your servant's house for a great while to come; and this [too] after the manner of men, Lord Yahweh! 007:020 What can David say more to you? for you know your servant, Lord Yahweh. 007:021 For your word's sake, and according to your own heart, have you worked all this greatness, to make your servant know it. 007:022 Therefore you are great, Yahweh God: for there is none like you, neither is there any God besides you, according to all

that we have heard with our ears.

007:023 What one nation in the earth is like your people, even like Israel, whom God went to redeem to himself for a people, and to make him a name, and to do great things for you, and awesome things for your land, before your people, whom you redeem to you out of Egypt, [from] the nations and their gods? 007:024 You did establish to yourself your people Israel to be a people to you forever; and you, Yahweh, became their God.

007:025 Now, Yahweh God, the word that you have spoken concerning your servant, and concerning his house, confirm you

it forever, and do as you have spoken. 007:026 Let your name be magnified forever, saying, Yahweh of Armies is God over Israel; and the house of your servant David shall be established before you. 007:027 For you, Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, have revealed to your servant, saying, I will build you a house: therefore has your servant found in his heart to pray this prayer to you. 007:028 Now, O Lord Yahweh, you are God, and your words are truth, and you have promised this good thing to your servant: 007:029 now therefore let it please you to bless the house of your servant, that it

**may continue forever before you;
for you, Lord Yahweh, have spoken
it: and with your blessing let the
house of your servant be blessed
forever. 008:001 After this it
happened that David struck the
Philistines, and subdued them: and
David took the bridle of the mother
city out of the hand of the
Philistines. 008:002 He struck
Moab, and measured them with the
line, making them to lie down on
the ground; and he measured two
lines to put to death, and one full
line to keep alive. The Moabites
became servants to David, and
brought tribute. 008:003 David
struck also Hadadezer the son of**

Rehob, king of Zobah, as he went to recover his dominion at the River. 008:004 David took from him one thousand seven hundred horsemen, and twenty thousand footmen: and David hamstringed all the chariot horses, but reserved of them for one hundred chariots.

008:005 When the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David struck of the Syrians two and twenty thousand men. 008:006 Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus; and the Syrians became servants to David, and brought tribute.

Yahweh gave victory to David wherever he went. 008:007 David

took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem.

008:008 From Betah and from Berothai, cities of Hadadezer, king David took exceeding much brass.

008:009 When Toi king of Hamath heard that David had struck all the army of Hadadezer, 008:010 then Toi sent Joram his son to king David, to Greet him, and to bless him, because he had fought against Hadadezer and struck him: for Hadadezer had wars with Toi.

[Joram] brought with him vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and vessels of brass: 008:011 These also did king David dedicate to Yahweh,

with the silver and gold that he dedicated of all the nations which he subdued; 008:012 of Syria, and of Moab, and of the children of Ammon, and of the Philistines, and of Amalek, and of the spoil of Hadadezer, son of Rehob, king of Zobah. 008:013 David got him a name when he returned from smiting the Syrians in the Valley of Salt, even eighteen thousand men. 008:014 He put garrisons in Edom; throughout all Edom put he garrisons, and all the Edomites became servants to David. Yahweh gave victory to David wherever he went. 008:015 David reigned over all Israel; and David executed

justice and righteousness to all his people. 008:016 Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the army; and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder; 008:017 and Zadok the son of Ahitub, and Ahimelech the son of Abiathar, were priests; and Seraiah was scribe; 008:018 and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada [was over] the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and David's sons were chief ministers. 009:001 David said, Is there yet any who is left of the house of Saul, that I may show him kindness for Jonathan's sake? 009:002 There was of the house of Saul a servant whose name was Ziba, and they called him to David;

and the king said to him, Are you Ziba? He said, Your servant is he. 009:003 The king said, Is there not yet any of the house of Saul, that I may show the kindness of God to him? Ziba said to the king, Jonathan has yet a son, who is lame of his feet. 009:004 The king said to him, Where is he? Ziba said to the king, Behold, he is in the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, in Lo Debar. 009:005 Then king David sent, and fetched him out of the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, from Lo Debar. 009:006 Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, came to David, and fell on his face, and did obeisance.

David said, Mephibosheth. He answered, Behold, your servant!
009:007 David said to him, "Don't be afraid of him; for I will surely show you kindness for Jonathan your father's sake, and will restore you all the land of Saul your father; and you shall eat bread at my table continually." 009:008 He did obeisance, and said, "What is your servant, that you should look on such a dead dog as I am?" 009:009 Then the king called to Ziba, Saul's servant, and said to him, "All that pertained to Saul and to all his house have I given to your master's son. 009:010 You shall till the land for him, you, and your sons, and

your servants; and you shall bring in [the fruits], that your master's son may have bread to eat: but Mephibosheth your master's son shall eat bread always at my table."

Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants. 009:011 Then said Ziba to the king, According to all that my lord the king commands his servant, so shall your servant do. As for Mephibosheth, [said the king], he shall eat at my table, as one of the king's sons. 009:012

Mephibosheth had a young son, whose name was Mica. All that lived in the house of Ziba were servants to Mephibosheth. 009:013 So Mephibosheth lived in

Jerusalem; for he ate continually at the king's table. He was lame in both his feet. 010:001 It happened after this, that the king of the children of Ammon died, and Hanun his son reigned in his place. 010:002 David said, I will show kindness to Hanun the son of Nahash, as his father shown kindness to me. So David sent by his servants to comfort him concerning his father. David's servants came into the land of the children of Ammon. 010:003 But the princes of the children of Ammon said to Hanun their lord, Do you think that David honors your father, in that he has sent

comforters to you? Hasn't David sent his servants to you to search the city, and to spy it out, and to overthrow it? 010:004 So Hanun took David's servants, and shaved off the one half of their beards, and cut off their garments in the middle, even to their buttocks, and sent them away. 010:005 When they told it to David, he sent to meet them; for the men were greatly ashamed. The king said, Wait at Jericho until your beards be grown, and then return. 010:006 When the children of Ammon saw that they were become odious to David, the children of Ammon sent and hired the Syrians of Beth Rehob, and the

Syrians of Zobah, twenty thousand footmen, and the king of Maacah with one thousand men, and the men of Tob twelve thousand men.

010:007 When David heard of it, he sent Joab, and all the army of the mighty men. 010:008 The children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array at the entrance of the gate: and the Syrians of Zobah and of Rehob, and the men of Tob and Maacah, were by themselves in the field. 010:009 Now when Joab saw that the battle was set against him before and behind, he chose of all the choice men of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians: 010:010 The rest of the people he

committed into the hand of Abishai his brother; and he put them in array against the children of Ammon. 010:011 He said, If the Syrians be too strong for me, then you shall help me; but if the children of Ammon be too strong for you, then I will come and help you. 010:012 Be of good courage, and let us play the man for our people, and for the cities of our God: and Yahweh do that which seems him good. 010:013 So Joab and the people who were with him drew near to the battle against the Syrians: and they fled before him. 010:014 When the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians were

fled, they likewise fled before Abishai, and entered into the city. Then Joab returned from the children of Ammon, and came to Jerusalem. 010:015 When the Syrians saw that they were put to the worse before Israel, they gathered themselves together. 010:016 Hadarezer sent, and brought out the Syrians who were beyond the River: and they came to Helam, with Shobach the captain of the army of Hadarezer at their head. 010:017 It was told David; and he gathered all Israel together, and passed over the Jordan, and came to Helam. The Syrians set themselves in array against David,

**and fought with him. 010:018 The
Syrians fled before Israel; and
David killed of the Syrians [the
men of] seven hundred chariots,
and forty thousand horsemen, and
struck Shobach the captain of their
army, so that he died there. 010:019
When all the kings who were
servants to Hadarezer saw that
they were put to the worse before
Israel, they made peace with Israel,
and served them. So the Syrians
feared to help the children of
Ammon any more. 011:001 It
happened, at the return of the year,
at the time when kings go out [to
battle], that David sent Joab, and
his servants with him, and all**

Israel; and they destroyed the children of Ammon, and besieged Rabbah. But David stayed at Jerusalem. 011:002 It happened at evening, that David arose from off his bed, and walked on the roof of the king's house: and from the roof he saw a woman bathing; and the woman was very beautiful to look on. 011:003 David send and inquired after the woman. One said, Is not this Bathsheba, the daughter of Eliam, the wife of Uriah the Hittite? 011:004 David sent messengers, and took her; and she came in to him, and he lay with her (for she was purified from her uncleanness); and she returned to

her house. 011:005 The woman conceived; and she sent and told David, and said, I am with child. 011:006 David sent to Joab, [saying], Send me Uriah the Hittite. Joab sent Uriah to David. 011:007 When Uriah was come to him, David asked of him how Joab did, and how the people fared, and how the war prospered. 011:008 David said to Uriah, Go down to your house, and wash your feet. Uriah departed out of the king's house, and there followed him a mess [of food] from the king. 011:009 But Uriah slept at the door of the king's house with all the servants of his lord, and didn't go down to his

house. 011:010 When they had told David, saying, Uriah didn't go down to his house, David said to Uriah, Haven't you come from a journey? why did you not go down to your house? 011:011 Uriah said to David, The ark, and Israel, and Judah, abide in booths; and my lord Joab, and the servants of my lord, are encamped in the open field; shall I then go into my house, to eat and to drink, and to lie with my wife? as you live, and as your soul lives, I will not do this thing. 011:012 David said to Uriah, Stay here today also, and tomorrow I will let you depart. So Uriah abode in Jerusalem that day, and the next

day. 011:013 When David had called him, he ate and drink before him; and he made him drunk: and at even he went out to lie on his bed with the servants of his lord, but didn't go down to his house.

011:014 It happened in the morning, that David wrote a letter to Joab, and sent it by the hand of Uriah. 011:015 He wrote in the letter, saying, Set Uriah in the forefront of the hottest battle, and retire you from him, that he may be struck, and die. 011:016 It happened, when Joab kept watch on the city, that he assigned Uriah to the place where he knew that valiant men were. 011:017 The men

of the city went out, and fought with Joab: and there fell some of the people, even of the servants of David; and Uriah the Hittite died also. 011:018 Then Joab sent and told David all the things concerning the war; 011:019 and he charged the messenger, saying, "When you have made an end of telling all the things concerning the war to the king, 011:020 it shall be that, if the king's wrath arise, and he tells you, 'Why did you go so near to the city to fight? Didn't you know that they would shoot from the wall? 011:021 who struck Abimelech the son of Jerubbesheth? Didn't a woman cast an upper millstone on him

from the wall, so that he died at Thebez? Why did you go so near the wall?' then shall you say, 'Your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also.'" 011:022 So the messenger went, and came and shown David all that Joab had sent him for. 011:023 The messenger said to David, The men prevailed against us, and came out to us into the field, and we were on them even to the entrance of the gate. 011:024 The shooters shot at your servants from off the wall; and some of the king's servants are dead, and your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also. 011:025 Then David said to the messenger, Thus shall you tell

Joab, Don't let this thing displease you, for the sword devours one as well as another; make your battle more strong against the city, and overthrow it: and encourage you him. 011:026 When the wife of Uriah heard that Uriah her husband was dead, she made lamentation for her husband. 011:027 When the mourning was past, David sent and took her home to his house, and she became his wife, and bore him a son. But the thing that David had done displeased Yahweh. 012:001 Yahweh sent Nathan to David. He came to him, and said to him, "There were two men in one city;

**the one rich, and the other poor.
012:002 The rich man had very
many flocks and herds, 012:003 but
the poor man had nothing, except
one little ewe lamb, which he had
bought and raised. It grew up
together with him, and with his
children. It ate of his own food,
drank of his own cup, and lay in his
bosom, and was to him like a
daughter. 012:004 A traveler came
to the rich man, and he spared to
take of his own flock and of his own
herd, to dress for the wayfaring
man who had come to him, but
took the poor man's lamb, and
dressed it for the man who had
come to him." 012:005 David's**

**anger was greatly kindled against the man, and he said to Nathan,
"As Yahweh lives, the man who has done this is worthy to die! 012:006
He shall restore the lamb fourfold, because he did this thing, and because he had no pity!" 012:007
Nathan said to David, "You are the man. This is what Yahweh, the God of Israel, says: 'I anointed you king over Israel, and I delivered you out of the hand of Saul. 012:008 I gave you your master's house, and your master's wives into your bosom, and gave you the house of Israel and of Judah; and if that would have been too little, I would have added to you many more such**

things. 012:009 Why have you despised the word of Yahweh, to do that which is evil in his sight? You have struck Uriah the Hittite with the sword, and have taken his wife to be your wife, and have slain him with the sword of the children of Ammon. 012:010 Now therefore the sword will never depart from your house, because you have despised me, and have taken the wife of Uriah the Hittite to be your wife.' 012:011 This is what Yahweh says: 'Behold, I will raise up evil against you out of your own house; and I will take your wives before your eyes, and give them to your neighbor, and he will lie with your

wives in the sight of this sun.

012:012 For you did it secretly, but I will do this thing before all Israel, and before the sun.'" 012:013

David said to Nathan, "I have sinned against Yahweh." Nathan said to David, "Yahweh also has put away your sin. You will not die.

012:014 However, because by this deed you have given great occasion to Yahweh's enemies to blaspheme, the child also who is born to you shall surely die." 012:015 Nathan

departed to his house. Yahweh struck the child that Uriah's wife bore to David, and it was very sick.

012:016 David therefore begged God for the child; and David

fasted, and went in, and lay all night on the earth. 012:017 The elders of his house arose, [and stood] beside him, to raise him up from the earth: but he would not, neither did he eat bread with them. 012:018 It happened on the seventh day, that the child died. The servants of David feared to tell him that the child was dead; for they said, Behold, while the child was yet alive, we spoke to him, and he didn't listen to our voice: how will he then vex himself, if we tell him that the child is dead! 012:019 But when David saw that his servants were whispering together, David perceived that the child was dead;

and David said to his servants, Is the child dead? They said, He is dead. 012:020 Then David arose from the earth, and washed, and anointed himself, and changed his clothing; and he came into the house of Yahweh, and worshiped: then he came to his own house; and when he required, they set bread before him, and he ate. 012:021 Then said his servants to him, What thing is this that you have done? you did fast and weep for the child, while it was alive; but when the child was dead, you did rise and eat bread. 012:022 He said, While the child was yet alive, I fasted and wept: for I said, Who knows

**whether Yahweh will not be
gracious to me, that the child may
live? 012:023 But now he is dead,
why should I fast? can I bring him
back again? I shall go to him, but
he will not return to me. 012:024**

**David comforted Bathsheba his
wife, and went in to her, and lay
with her: and she bore a son, and
he called his name Solomon.**

**Yahweh loved him; 012:025 and he
sent by the hand of Nathan the
prophet; and he named him
Jedidiah, for Yahweh's sake.**

**012:026 Now Joab fought against
Rabbah of the children of Ammon,
and took the royal city. 012:027**

Joab sent messengers to David, and

**said, I have fought against Rabbah;
yes, I have taken the city of waters.**

**012:028 Now therefore gather the
rest of the people together, and
encamp against the city, and take
it; lest I take the city, and it be
called after my name. 012:029**

**David gathered all the people
together, and went to Rabbah, and
fought against it, and took it.**

**012:030 He took the crown of their
king from off his head; and the
weight of it was a talent of gold,
and [in it were] precious stones;
and it was set on David's head. He
brought forth the spoil of the city,
exceeding much. 012:031 He
brought forth the people who were**

**therein, and put them under saws,
and under harrows of iron, and
under axes of iron, and made them
pass through the brick kiln: and
thus did he to all the cities of the
children of Ammon. David and all
the people returned to Jerusalem.**

**013:001 It happened after this, that
Absalom the son of David had a
beautiful sister, whose name was
Tamar; and Amnon the son of
David loved her. 013:002 Amnon
was so vexed that he fell sick
because of his sister Tamar; for she
was a virgin; and it seemed hard to
Amnon to do anything to her.**

**013:003 But Amnon had a friend,
whose name was Jonadab, the son**

of Shimeah, David's brother; and Jonadab was a very subtle man.

013:004 He said to him, Why, son of the king, are you thus lean from day to day? Won't you tell me?

Amnon said to him, I love Tamar, my brother Absalom's sister.

013:005 Jonadab said to him, Lay you down on your bed, and feign yourself sick: and when your father comes to see you, tell him, Please let my sister Tamar come and give me bread to eat, and dress the food in my sight, that I may see it, and eat it from her hand. 013:006 So

Amnon lay down, and feigned himself sick: and when the king was come to see him, Amnon said

**to the king, Please let her sister
Tamar come, and make me a
couple of cakes in my sight, that I
may eat from her hand. 013:007
Then David sent home to Tamar,
saying, Go now to your brother
Amnon's house, and dress him
food. 013:008 So Tamar went to her
brother Amnon's house; and he
was laid down. She took dough,
and kneaded it, and made cakes in
his sight, and did bake the cakes.
013:009 She took the pan, and
poured them out before him; but he
refused to eat. Amnon said, Have
out all men from me. They went out
every man from him. 013:010
Amnon said to Tamar, Bring the**

food into the chamber, that I may eat from your hand. Tamar took the cakes which she had made, and brought them into the chamber to Amnon her brother. 013:011 When she had brought them near to him to eat, he took hold of her, and said to her, Come, lie with me, my sister. 013:012 She answered him, No, my brother, do not force me; for no such thing ought to be done in Israel. Don't you do this folly. 013:013 I, where shall I carry my shame? and as for you, you will be as one of the fools in Israel. Now therefore, please speak to the king; for he will not withhold me from you. 013:014 However he would not

listen to her voice; but being stronger than she, he forced her, and lay with her. 013:015 Then Amnon hated her with exceeding great hatred; for the hatred with which he hated her was greater than the love with which he had loved her. Amnon said to her, Arise, be gone. 013:016 She said to him, Not so, because this great wrong in putting me forth is [worse] than the other that you did to me. But he would not listen to her. 013:017 Then he called his servant who ministered to him, and said, Put now this woman out from me, and bolt the door after her. 013:018 She had a garment of various colors on

her; for with such robes were the king's daughters who were virgins dressed. Then his servant brought her out, and bolted the door after her. 013:019 Tamar put ashes on her head, and tore her garment of various colors that was on her; and she laid her hand on her head, and went her way, crying aloud as she went. 013:020 Absalom her brother said to her, Has Amnon your brother been with you? but now hold your peace, my sister: he is your brother; don't take this thing to heart. So Tamar remained desolate in her brother Absalom's house. 013:021 But when king David heard of all these things, he

was very angry. 013:022 Absalom spoke to Amnon neither good nor bad; for Absalom hated Amnon, because he had forced his sister Tamar. 013:023 It happened after two full years, that Absalom had sheepshearers in Baal Hazor, which is beside Ephraim: and Absalom invited all the king's sons. 013:024 Absalom came to the king, and said, See now, your servant has sheepshearers; let the king, I pray you, and his servants go with your servant. 013:025 The king said to Absalom, No, my son, let us not all go, lest we be burdensome to you. He pressed him: however he would not go, but blessed him. 013:026

Then said Absalom, If not, please let my brother Amnon go with us. The king said to him, Why should he go with you? 013:027 But Absalom pressed him, and he let Amnon and all the king's sons go with him. 013:028 Absalom commanded his servants, saying, Mark you now, when Amnon's heart is merry with wine; and when I tell you, Smite Amnon, then kill him; don't be afraid; haven't I commanded you? be courageous, and be valiant. 013:029 The servants of Absalom did to Amnon as Absalom had commanded. Then all the king's sons arose, and every man got him up on his mule, and

fled. 013:030 It happened, while they were in the way, that the news came to David, saying, Absalom has slain all the king's sons, and there is not one of them left. 013:031 Then the king arose, and tore his garments, and lay on the earth; and all his servants stood by with their clothes torn. 013:032 Jonadab, the son of Shimeah, David's brother, answered, Don't let my lord suppose that they have killed all the young men the king's sons; for Amnon only is dead; for by the appointment of Absalom this has been determined from the day that he forced his sister Tamar. 013:033 Now therefore don't let my lord the

king take the thing to his heart, to think that all the king's sons are dead; for Amnon only is dead.

013:034 But Absalom fled. The young man who kept the watch lifted up his eyes, and looked, and behold, many people were coming by way of the hillside behind him.

013:035 Jonadab said to the king, Behold, the king's sons are come: as your servant said, so it is.

013:036 It happened, as soon as he had made an end of speaking, that behold, the king's sons came, and lifted up their voice, and wept: and the king also and all his servants wept very sore. 013:037 But

Absalom fled, and went to Talmai

the son of Ammihur, king of Geshur. [David] mourned for his son every day. 013:038 So Absalom fled, and went to Geshur, and was there three years. 013:039 [the soul of] king David longed to go forth to Absalom: for he was comforted concerning Amnon, seeing he was dead. 014:001 Now Joab the son of Zeruah perceived that the king's heart was toward Absalom. 014:002 Joab sent to Tekoa, and fetched there a wise woman, and said to her, please act like a mourner, and put on mourning clothing, Please, and don't anoint yourself with oil, but be as a woman who has a long time mourned for the dead:

014:003 and go in to the king, and speak on this manner to him. So Joab put the words in her mouth.

014:004 When the woman of Tekoa spoke to the king, she fell on her face to the ground, and did obeisance, and said, Help, O king.

014:005 The king said to her, What ails you? She answered, Of a truth I am a widow, and my husband is dead. 014:006 Your handmaid had two sons, and they two strove together in the field, and there was none to part them, but the one struck the other, and killed him.

014:007 Behold, the whole family is risen against your handmaid, and they say, Deliver him who struck

his brother, that we may kill him for the life of his brother whom he killed, and so destroy the heir also. Thus will they quench my coal which is left, and will leave to my husband neither name nor remainder on the surface of the earth. 014:008 The king said to the woman, Go to your house, and I will give charge concerning you. 014:009 The woman of Tekoa said to the king, My lord, O king, the iniquity be on me, and on my father's house; and the king and his throne be guiltless. 014:010 The king said, Whoever says anything to you, bring him to me, and he shall not touch you any more.

014:011 Then said she, Please let the king remember Yahweh your God, that the avenger of blood destroy not any more, lest they destroy my son. He said, As Yahweh lives, there shall not one hair of your son fall to the earth.

014:012 Then the woman said, Please let your handmaid speak a word to my lord the king. He said, Say on. 014:013 The woman said, Why then have you devised such a thing against the people of God? for in speaking this word the king is as one who is guilty, in that the king does not bring home again his banished one. 014:014 For we must needs die, and are as water split on

the ground, which can't be gathered up again; neither does God take away life, but devises means, that he who is banished not be an outcast from him. 014:015

Now therefore seeing that I have come to speak this word to my lord the king, it is because the people have made me afraid: and your handmaid said, I will now speak to the king; it may be that the king will perform the request of his servant. 014:016 For the king will hear, to deliver his servant out of the hand of the man who would destroy me and my son together out of the inheritance of God. 014:017

Then your handmaid said, Please

let the word of my lord the king be comfortable; for as an angel of God, so is my lord the king to discern good and bad: and Yahweh your God be with you. 014:018

Then the king answered the woman, Please don't hide anything from me that I shall ask you. The woman said, Let my lord the king now speak. 014:019 The king said, Is the hand of Joab with you in all this? The woman answered, As your soul lives, my lord the king, none can turn to the right hand or to the left from anything that my lord the king has spoken; for your servant Joab, he bade me, and he put all these words in the mouth of

your handmaid; 014:020 to change the face of the matter has your servant Joab done this thing: and my lord is wise, according to the wisdom of an angel of God, to know all things that are in the earth. 014:021 The king said to Joab, Behold now, I have done this thing: go therefore, bring the young man Absalom back. 014:022 Joab fell to the ground on his face, and did obeisance, and blessed the king: and Joab said, Today your servant knows that I have found favor in your sight, my lord, king, in that the king has performed the request of his servant. 014:023 So Joab arose and went to Geshur, and

brought Absalom to Jerusalem.

014:024 The king said, Let him turn to his own house, but let him not see my face. So Absalom turned to his own house, and didn't see the king's face. 014:025 Now in all

Israel there was none to be so much praised as Absalom for his beauty: from the sole of his foot even to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him. 014:026 When he cut the hair of his head (now it was at every year's end that he cut it; because it was heavy on him, therefore he cut it); he weighed the hair of his head at two hundred shekels, after the king's weight.

014:027 To Absalom there were

**born three sons, and one daughter,
whose name was Tamar: she was a
woman of a beautiful face. 014:028**

**Absalom lived two full years in
Jerusalem; and he didn't see the
king's face. 014:029 Then Absalom
sent for Joab, to send him to the
king; but he would not come to
him: and he sent again a second
time, but he would not come.**

**014:030 Therefore he said to his
servants, Behold, Joab's field is
near mine, and he has barley there;
go and set it on fire. Absalom's
servants set the field on fire.**

**014:031 Then Joab arose, and came
to Absalom to his house, and said to
him, Why have your servants set**

my field on fire? 014:032 Absalom answered Joab, Behold, I sent to you, saying, Come here, that I may send you to the king, to say, Why am I come from Geshur? it were better for me to be there still. Now therefore let me see the king's face; and if there be iniquity in me, let him kill me. 014:033 So Joab came to the king, and told him; and when he had called for Absalom, he came to the king, and bowed himself on his face to the ground before the king: and the king kissed Absalom. 015:001 It happened after this, that Absalom prepared him a chariot and horses, and fifty men to run before him. 015:002 Absalom rose

up early, and stood beside the way of the gate: and it was so, that when any man had a suit which should come to the king for judgment, then Absalom called to him, and said, Of what city are you? He said, Your servant is of one of the tribes of Israel. 015:003 Absalom said to him, Behold, your matters are good and right; but there is no man deputed of the king to hear you. 015:004 Absalom said moreover, Oh that I were made judge in the land, that every man who has any suit or cause might come to me, and I would do him justice! 015:005 It was so, that when any man came near to do him obeisance, he put

forth his hand, and took hold of him, and kissed him. 015:006 In this manner Absalom did to all Israel who came to the king for judgment: so Absalom stole the hearts of the men of Israel. 015:007 It happened at the end of forty years, that Absalom said to the king, please let me go and pay my vow, which I have vowed to Yahweh, in Hebron. 015:008 For your servant vowed a vow while I abode at Geshur in Syria, saying, If Yahweh shall indeed bring me again to Jerusalem, then I will serve Yahweh. 015:009 The king said to him, Go in peace. So he arose, and went to Hebron. 015:010

But Absalom sent spies throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, As soon as you hear the sound of the trumpet, then you shall say, Absalom is king in Hebron. 015:011 With Absalom went two hundred men out of Jerusalem, who were invited, and went in their simplicity; and they didn't know anything. 015:012 Absalom sent for Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's counselor, from his city, even from Giloh, while he was offering the sacrifices. The conspiracy was strong; for the people increased continually with Absalom. 015:013 There came a messenger to David, saying, The hearts of the men of

Israel are after Absalom. 015:014 David said to all his servants who were with him at Jerusalem, Arise, and let us flee; for else none of us shall escape from Absalom: make speed to depart, lest he overtake us quickly, and bring down evil on us, and strike the city with the edge of the sword. 015:015 The king's servants said to the king, Behold, your servants are ready to do whatever my lord the king shall choose. 015:016 The king went forth, and all his household after him. The king left ten women, who were concubines, to keep the house. 015:017 The king went forth, and all the people after him; and they

stayed in Beth Merhak. 015:018 All his servants passed on beside him; and all the Cherethites, and all the Pelethites, and all the Gittites, six hundred men who came after him from Gath, passed on before the king. 015:019 Then said the king to Ittai the Gittite, Why go you also with us? return, and abide with the king: for you are a foreigner, and also an exile; [return] to your own place. 015:020 Whereas you came but yesterday, should I this day make you go up and down with us, seeing I go where I may? return you, and take back your brothers; mercy and truth be with you. 015:021 Ittai answered the king,

and said, As Yahweh lives, and as my lord the king lives, surely in what place my lord the king shall be, whether for death or for life, even there also will your servant be.

015:022 David said to Ittai, Go and pass over. Ittai the Gittite passed over, and all his men, and all the little ones who were with him.

015:023 All the country wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over: the king also himself passed over the brook Kidron, and all the people passed over, toward the way of the wilderness. 015:024 Behold, Zadok also [came], and all the Levites with him, bearing the ark of the covenant of God; and

they set down the ark of God; and Abiathar went up, until all the people had done passing out of the city. 015:025 The king said to Zadok, Carry back the ark of God into the city: if I shall find favor in the eyes of Yahweh, he will bring me again, and show me both it, and his habitation: 015:026 but if he say thus, I have no delight in you; behold, here am I, let him do to me as seems good to him. 015:027 The king said also to Zadok the priest, "Aren't you a seer? Return into the city in peace, and your two sons with you, Ahimaaz your son, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar. 015:028 Behold, I will stay at the

fords of the wilderness, until word comes from you to inform me."

015:029 Zadok therefore and Abiathar carried the ark of God again to Jerusalem: and they abode there. 015:030 David went up by the ascent of the [Mount of] Olives, and wept as he went up; and he had his head covered, and went barefoot: and all the people who were with him covered every man his head, and they went up, weeping as they went up. 015:031 One told David, saying, Ahithophel is among the conspirators with Absalom. David said, Yahweh, please turn the counsel of Ahithophel into foolishness.

015:032 It happened that when David had come to the top [of the ascent], where God was worshiped, behold, Hushai the Archite came to meet him with his coat torn, and earth on his head. 015:033 David said to him, If you pass on with me, then you will be a burden to me: 015:034 but if you return to the city, and tell Absalom, I will be your servant, O king; as I have been your father's servant in time past, so will I now be your servant; then will you defeat for me the counsel of Ahithophel. 015:035 Don't you have Zadok and Abiathar the priests there with you? therefore it shall be, that

whatever thing you shall hear out of the king's house, you shall tell it to Zadok and Abiathar the priests. 015:036 Behold, they have there with them their two sons, Ahimaaz, Zadok's son, and Jonathan, Abiathar's son; and by them you shall send to me everything that you shall hear. 015:037 So Hushai, David's friend, came into the city; and Absalom came into Jerusalem. 016:001 When David was a little past the top [of the ascent], behold, Ziba the servant of Mephibosheth met him, with a couple of donkeys saddled, and on them two hundred loaves of bread, and one hundred clusters of raisins, and one hundred

summer fruits, and a bottle of wine.

016:002 The king said to Ziba,

What do you mean by these? Ziba said, The donkeys are for the king's household to ride on; and the bread and summer fruit for the young men to eat; and the wine, that such as are faint in the wilderness may drink. 016:003 The king said, Where is your master's son? Ziba said to the king, Behold, he abides at Jerusalem; for he said, Today will the house of Israel restore me the kingdom of my father. 016:004 Then said the king to Ziba, Behold, all that pertains to Mephibosheth is yours. Ziba said, I do obeisance; let me find favor in your sight, my

lord, O king. 016:005 When king David came to Bahurim, behold, a man of the family of the house of Saul came out, whose name was Shimei, the son of Gera. He came out, and cursed still as he came. 016:006 He cast stones at David, and at all the servants of king David: and all the people and all the mighty men were on his right hand and on his left. 016:007 Thus said Shimei when he cursed, Be gone, be gone, you man of blood, and base fellow: 016:008 Yahweh has returned on you all the blood of the house of Saul, in whose place you have reigned; and Yahweh has delivered the kingdom into the

**hand of Absalom your son; and
behold, you are [taken] in your own
mischief, because you are a man of
blood. 016:009 Then said Abishai
the son of Zeruiah to the king,
"Why should this dead dog curse
my lord the king? Please let me go
over and take off his head."
016:010 The king said, What have I
to do with you, you sons of
Zeruiah? Because he curses, and
because Yahweh has said to him,
Curse David; who then shall say,
Why have you done so? 016:011
David said to Abishai, and to all his
servants, Behold, my son, who
came forth from my bowels, seeks
my life: how much more [may] this**

Benjamite now [do it]? let him alone, and let him curse; for Yahweh has invited him. 016:012 It may be that Yahweh will look on the wrong done to me, and that Yahweh will requite me good for [his] cursing of me this day.

016:013 So David and his men went by the way; and Shimei went along on the hillside over against him, and cursed as he went, and threw stones at him, and cast dust.

016:014 The king, and all the people who were with him, came weary; and he refreshed himself there. 016:015 Absalom, and all the people, the men of Israel, came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel with

him. 016:016 It happened, when Hushai the Archite, David's friend, was come to Absalom, that Hushai said to Absalom, [Long] live the king, [Long] live the king. 016:017 Absalom said to Hushai, Is this your kindness to your friend? Why didn't you go with your friend? 016:018 Hushai said to Absalom, No; but whom Yahweh, and this people, and all the men of Israel have chosen, his will I be, and with him will I abide. 016:019 Again, whom should I serve? Shouldn't I serve in the presence of his son? as I have served in your father's presence, so will I be in your presence. 016:020 Then said

Absalom to Ahithophel, Give your counsel what we shall do. 016:021

Ahithophel said to Absalom, Go in to your father's concubines, that he has left to keep the house; and all Israel will hear that you are

abhorred of your father: then will the hands of all who are with you be strong. 016:022 So they spread

Absalom a tent on the top of the house; and Absalom went in to his father's concubines in the sight of

all Israel. 016:023 The counsel of Ahithophel, which he gave in those

days, was as if a man inquired at the oracle of God: so was all the

counsel of Ahithophel both with

David and with Absalom. 017:001

Moreover Ahithophel said to Absalom, Let me now choose out twelve thousand men, and I will arise and pursue after David this night: 017:002 and I will come on him while he is weary and exhausted, and will make him afraid; and all the people who are with him shall flee; and I will strike the king only; 017:003 and I will bring back all the people to you: the man whom you seek is as if all returned: [so] all the people shall be in peace. 017:004 The saying pleased Absalom well, and all the elders of Israel. 017:005 Then said Absalom, Call now Hushai the Archite also, and let us hear

likewise what he says. 017:006

**When Hushai was come to
Absalom, Absalom spoke to him,
saying, Ahithophel has spoken after
this manner: shall we do [after] his
saying? if not, speak up. 017:007**

**Hushai said to Absalom, The
counsel that Ahithophel has given
this time is not good. 017:008**

**Hushai said moreover, You know
your father and his men, that they
are mighty men, and they are fierce
in their minds, as a bear robbed of
her cubs in the field; and your
father is a man of war, and will not
lodge with the people. 017:009**

**Behold, he is hid now in some pit,
or in some [other] place: and it will**

**happen, when some of them are
fallen at the first, that whoever
hears it will say, There is a
slaughter among the people who
follow Absalom. 017:010 Even he
who is valiant, whose heart is as the
heart of a lion, will utterly melt; for
all Israel knows that your father is
a mighty man, and those who are
with him are valiant men. 017:011
But I counsel that all Israel be
gathered together to you, from Dan
even to Beersheba, as the sand that
is by the sea for multitude; and that
you go to battle in your own
person. 017:012 So shall we come
on him in some place where he
shall be found, and we will light on**

**him as the dew falls on the ground;
and of him and of all the men who
are with him we will not leave so
much as one. 017:013 Moreover, if
he be gotten into a city, then shall
all Israel bring ropes to that city,
and we will draw it into the river,
until there not be one small stone
found there. 017:014 Absalom and
all the men of Israel said, The
counsel of Hushai the Archite is
better than the counsel of
Ahithophel. For Yahweh had
ordained to defeat the good counsel
of Ahithophel, to the intent that
Yahweh might bring evil on
Absalom. 017:015 Then said
Hushai to Zadok and to Abiathar**

the priests, Thus and thus did Ahithophel counsel Absalom and the elders of Israel; and thus and thus have I counseled. 017:016 Now therefore send quickly, and tell David, saying, Don't lodge this night at the fords of the wilderness, but by all means pass over; lest the king be swallowed up, and all the people who are with him. 017:017 Now Jonathan and Ahimaaz were staying by En Rogel; and a female servant used to go and tell them; and they went and told king David: for they might not be seen to come into the city. 017:018 But a boy saw them, and told Absalom: and they went both of them away quickly,

and came to the house of a man in Bahurim, who had a well in his court; and they went down there.

017:019 The woman took and spread the covering over the well's mouth, and strewed bruised grain thereon; and nothing was known.

017:020 Absalom's servants came to the woman to the house; and they said, Where are Ahimaaz and Jonathan? The woman said to them, They have gone over the brook of water. When they had sought and could not find them, they returned to Jerusalem.

017:021 It happened, after they had departed, that they came up out of the well, and went and told king

**David; and they said to David,
Arise you, and pass quickly over
the water; for thus has Ahithophel
counseled against you. 017:022**

**Then David arose, and all the
people who were with him, and
they passed over the Jordan: by the
morning light there lacked not one
of them who had not gone over the
Jordan. 017:023 When Ahithophel
saw that his counsel was not
followed, he saddled his donkey,
and arose, and got him home, to his
city, and set his house in order, and
hanged himself; and he died, and
was buried in the tomb of his
father. 017:024 Then David came to
Mahanaim. Absalom passed over**

the Jordan, he and all the men of Israel with him. 017:025 Absalom set Amasa over the army instead of Joab. Now Amasa was the son of a man, whose name was Ithra the Israelite, who went in to Abigail the daughter of Nahash, sister to Zeruah, Joab's mother. 017:026 Israel and Absalom encamped in the land of Gilead. 017:027 It happened, when David was come to Mahanaim, that Shobi the son of Nahash of Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and Machir the son of Ammiel of Lodebar, and Barzillai the Gileadite of Rogelim, 017:028 brought beds, and basins, and earthen vessels, and wheat, and

barley, and meal, and parched [grain], and beans, and lentils, and parched [pulse], 017:029 and honey, and butter, and sheep, and cheese of the herd, for David, and for the people who were with him, to eat: for they said, The people are hungry, and weary, and thirsty, in the wilderness. 018:001 David numbered the people who were with him, and set captains of thousands and captains of hundreds over them. 018:002 David sent forth the people, a third part under the hand of Joab, and a third part under the hand of Abishai the son of Zeruah, Joab's brother, and a third part under the hand of Ittai

the Gittite. The king said to the people, I will surely go forth with you myself also. 018:003 But the people said, You shall not go forth: for if we flee away, they will not care for us; neither if half of us die, will they care for us: but you are worth ten thousand of us; therefore now it is better that you are ready to help us out of the city. 018:004 The king said to them, What seems you best I will do. The king stood beside the gate, and all the people went out by hundreds and by thousands. 018:005 The king commanded Joab and Abishai and Ittai, saying, Deal gently for my sake with the young man, even with

Absalom. All the people heard when the king gave all the captains charge concerning Absalom.

018:006 So the people went out into the field against Israel: and the battle was in the forest of Ephraim.

018:007 The people of Israel were struck there before the servants of David, and there was a great slaughter there that day of twenty thousand men. 018:008 For the battle was there spread over the surface of all the country; and the forest devoured more people that day than the sword devoured.

018:009 Absalom happened to meet the servants of David. Absalom was riding on his mule, and the mule

went under the thick boughs of a great oak, and his head caught hold of the oak, and he was taken up between the sky and earth; and the mule that was under him went on.

018:010 A certain man saw it, and told Joab, and said, Behold, I saw Absalom hanging in an oak.

018:011 Joab said to the man who told him, Behold, you saw it, and why didn't you strike him there to the ground? and I would have given you ten [pieces of] silver, and a sash. 018:012 The man said to Joab, Though I should receive a thousand [pieces of] silver in my hand, I still wouldn't put forth my hand against the king's son; for in

our hearing the king charged you and Abishai and Ittai, saying, Beware that none touch the young man Absalom. 018:013 Otherwise if I had dealt falsely against his life (and there is no matter hid from the king), then you yourself would have set yourself against [me].

018:014 Then said Joab, I may not wait thus with you. He took three darts in his hand, and thrust them through the heart of Absalom, while he was yet alive in the midst of the oak. 018:015 Ten young men who bore Joab's armor compassed about and struck Absalom, and killed him. 018:016 Joab blew the trumpet, and the people returned

from pursuing after Israel; for Joab held back the people. 018:017 They took Absalom, and cast him into the great pit in the forest, and raised over him a very great heap of stones: and all Israel fled everyone to his tent. 018:018 Now Absalom in his lifetime had taken and reared up for himself the pillar, which is in the king's dale; for he said, I have no son to keep my name in memory: and he called the pillar after his own name; and it is called Absalom's monument, to this day. 018:019 Then said Ahimaaz the son of Zadok, Let me now run, and bear the king news, how that Yahweh has avenged him of his

**enemies. 018:020 Joab said to him,
You shall not be the bearer of news
this day, but you shall bear news
another day; but this day you shall
bear no news, because the king's
son is dead. 018:021 Then said Joab
to the Cushite, Go, tell the king
what you have seen. The Cushite
bowed himself to Joab, and ran.
018:022 Then said Ahimaaz the son
of Zadok yet again to Joab, But
come what may, Please let me also
run after the Cushite. Joab said,
Why will you run, my son, seeing
that you will have no reward for
the news? 018:023 But come what
may, [said he], I will run. He said to
him, Run. Then Ahimaaz ran by**

the way of the Plain, and outran the Cushite. 018:024 Now David was sitting between the two gates: and the watchman went up to the roof of the gate to the wall, and lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, a man running alone.

018:025 The watchman cried, and told the king. The king said, If he be alone, there is news in his mouth. He came apace, and drew near.

018:026 The watchman saw another man running; and the watchman called to the porter, and said, Behold, [another] man

running alone. The king said, He also brings news. 018:027 The

watchman said, I think the running

**of the foremost is like the running
of Ahimaaz the son of Zadok. The
king said, He is a good man, and
comes with good news. 018:028**

**Ahimaaz called, and said to the
king, All is well. He bowed himself
before the king with his face to the
earth, and said, Blessed be Yahweh
your God, who has delivered up the
men who lifted up their hand
against my lord the king. 018:029**

**The king said, Is it well with the
young man Absalom? Ahimaaz
answered, When Joab sent the
king's servant, even me your
servant, I saw a great tumult, but I
don't know what it was. 018:030**

The king said, Turn aside, and

stand here. He turned aside, and stood still. 018:031 Behold, the Cushite came; and the Cushite said, News for my lord the king; for Yahweh has avenged you this day of all those who rose up against you. 018:032 The king said to the Cushite, Is it well with the young man Absalom? The Cushite answered, The enemies of my lord the king, and all who rise up against you to do you hurt, be as that young man is. 018:033 The king was much moved, and went up to the chamber over the gate, and wept: and as he went, thus he said, my son Absalom, my son, my son Absalom! would I had died for you,

Absalom, my son, my son! 019:001

It was told Joab, Behold, the king weeps and mourns for Absalom.

019:002 The victory that day was turned into mourning to all the

people; for the people heard say that day, The king grieves for his

son. 019:003 The people got them

by stealth that day into the city, as people who are ashamed steal away

when they flee in battle. 019:004

The king covered his face, and the king cried with a loud voice, my

son Absalom, Absalom, my son, my

son! 019:005 Joab came into the

house to the king, and said, You

have shamed this day the faces of

all your servants, who this day have

**saved your life, and the lives of
your sons and of your daughters,
and the lives of your wives, and the
lives of your concubines; 019:006 in
that you love those who hate you,
and hate those who love you. For
you have declared this day, that
princes and servants are nothing to
you: for this day I perceive that if
Absalom had lived, and all we had
died this day, then it had pleased
you well. 019:007 Now therefore
arise, go forth, and speak
comfortably to your servants; for I
swear by Yahweh, if you don't go
forth, there will not stay a man
with you this night: and that will be
worse to you than all the evil that**

has happened to you from your youth until now. 019:008 Then the king arose, and sat in the gate. They told to all the people, saying, Behold, the king is sitting in the gate: and all the people came before the king. Now Israel had fled every man to his tent. 019:009 All the people were at strife throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, The king delivered us out of the hand of our enemies, and he saved us out of the hand of the Philistines; and now he is fled out of the land from Absalom. 019:010 Absalom, whom we anointed over us, is dead in battle. Now therefore why don't you speak a word of

**bringing the king back? 019:011
King David sent to Zadok and to
Abiathar the priests, saying, Speak
to the elders of Judah, saying, Why
are you the last to bring the king
back to his house? seeing the
speech of all Israel is come to the
king, [to bring him] to his house.
019:012 You are my brothers, you
are my bone and my flesh: why
then are you the last to bring back
the king? 019:013 Say you to
Amasa, Aren't you my bone and
my flesh? God do so to me, and
more also, if you aren't captain of
the army before me continually in
the room of Joab. 019:014 He
bowed the heart of all the men of**

Judah, even as [the heart of] one man; so that they sent to the king, [saying], Return you, and all your servants. 019:015 So the king returned, and came to the Jordan. Judah came to Gilgal, to go to meet the king, to bring the king over the Jordan. 019:016 Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjamite, who was of Bahurim, hurried and came down with the men of Judah to meet king David. 019:017 There were a thousand men of Benjamin with him, and Ziba the servant of the house of Saul, and his fifteen sons and his twenty servants with him; and they went through the Jordan in the presence of the king. 019:018

A ferry boat went to bring over the king's household, and to do what he thought good. Shimei the son of Gera fell down before the king, when he was come over the Jordan. 019:019 He said to the king, Don't let my lord impute iniquity to me, neither do you remember that which your servant did perversely the day that my lord the king went out of Jerusalem, that the king should take it to his heart. 019:020 For your servant does know that I have sinned: therefore, behold, I am come this day the first of all the house of Joseph to go down to meet my lord the king. 019:021 But Abishai the son of Zeruiah

answered, Shall Shimei not be put to death for this, because he cursed Yahweh's anointed? 019:022 David said, What have I to do with you, you sons of Zeruiah, that you should this day be adversaries to me? shall there any man be put to death this day in Israel? for don't I know that I am this day king over Israel? 019:023 The king said to Shimei, You shall not die. The king swore to him. 019:024

Mephibosheth the son of Saul came down to meet the king; and he had neither dressed his feet, nor trimmed his beard, nor washed his clothes, from the day the king departed until the day he came

home in peace. 019:025 It happened, when he was come to Jerusalem to meet the king, that the king said to him, Why didn't you go with me, Mephibosheth? 019:026 He answered, My lord, O king, my servant deceived me: for your servant said, I will saddle me a donkey, that I may ride thereon, and go with the king; because your servant is lame. 019:027 He has slandered your servant to my lord the king; but my lord the king is as an angel of God: do therefore what is good in your eyes. 019:028 For all my father's house were but dead men before my lord the king; yet you set your servant among those

who ate at your own table. What right therefore have I yet that I should cry any more to the king?
019:029 The king said to him, Why speak you any more of your matters? I say, You and Ziba divide the land. 019:030 Mephibosheth said to the king, yes, let him take all, because my lord the king is come in peace to his own house. 019:031 Barzillai the Gileadite came down from Rogelim; and he went over the Jordan with the king, to conduct him over the Jordan. 019:032 Now Barzillai was a very aged man, even eighty years old: and he had provided the king with sustenance while he lay at

Mahanaim; for he was a very great man. 019:033 The king said to Barzillai, Come you over with me, and I will sustain you with me in Jerusalem. 019:034 Barzillai said to the king, How many are the days of the years of my life, that I should go up with the king to Jerusalem? 019:035 I am this day eighty years old: can I discern between good and bad? can your servant taste what I eat or what I drink? can I hear any more the voice of singing men and singing women? why then should your servant be yet a burden to my lord the king? 019:036 Your servant would but just go over the Jordan with the

king: and why should the king recompense it me with such a reward? 019:037 Please let your servant turn back again, that I may die in my own city, by the grave of my father and my mother. But behold, your servant Chimham; let him go over with my lord the king; and do to him what shall seem good to you. 019:038 The king answered, Chimham shall go over with me, and I will do to him that which shall seem good to you: and whatever you shall require of me, that will I do for you. 019:039 All the people went over the Jordan, and the king went over: and the king kissed Barzillai, and blessed

him; and he returned to his own place. 019:040 So the king went over to Gilgal, and Chimham went over with him: and all the people of Judah brought the king over, and also half the people of Israel.

019:041 Behold, all the men of Israel came to the king, and said to the king, Why have our brothers the men of Judah stolen you away, and brought the king, and his household, over the Jordan, and all David's men with him? 019:042 All the men of Judah answered the men of Israel, Because the king is a close relative to us: why then are you angry for this matter? have we eaten at all at the king's cost? or

has he given us any gift? 019:043

The men of Israel answered the men of Judah, and said, We have ten parts in the king, and we have also more [right] in David than you: why then did you despise us, that our advice should not be first had in bringing back our king? The words of the men of Judah were fiercer than the words of the men of Israel. 020:001 There happened to be there a base fellow, whose name was Sheba, the son of Bichri, a Benjamite: and he blew the trumpet, and said, We have no portion in David, neither have we inheritance in the son of Jesse: every man to his tents, Israel.

020:002 So all the men of Israel went up from following David, and followed Sheba the son of Bichri; but the men of Judah joined with their king, from the Jordan even to Jerusalem. 020:003 David came to his house at Jerusalem; and the king took the ten women his concubines, whom he had left to keep the house, and put them in custody, and provided them with sustenance, but didn't go in to them. So they were shut up to the day of their death, living in widowhood. 020:004 Then said the king to Amasa, Call me the men of Judah together within three days, and be here present. 020:005 So

Amasa went to call [the men of] Judah together; but he stayed longer than the set time which he had appointed him. 020:006 David said to Abishai, Now will Sheba the son of Bichri do us more harm than did Absalom: take your lord's servants, and pursue after him, lest he get him fortified cities, and escape out of our sight. 020:007 There went out after him Joab's men, and the Cherethites and the Pelethites, and all the mighty men; and they went out of Jerusalem, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri. 020:008 When they were at the great stone which is in Gibeon, Amasa came to meet them. Joab

was girded with his apparel of war that he had put on, and thereon was a sash with a sword fastened on his waist in its sheath; and as he went forth it fell out. 020:009 Joab said to Amasa, Is it well with you, my brother? Joab took Amasa by the beard with his right hand to kiss him. 020:010 But Amasa took no heed to the sword that was in Joab's hand: so he struck him therewith in the body, and shed out his bowels to the ground, and didn't strike him again; and he died. Joab and Abishai his brother pursued after Sheba the son of Bichri. 020:011 There stood by him one of Joab's young men, and said,

He who favors Joab, and he who is for David, let him follow Joab.

020:012 Amasa lay wallowing in his blood in the midst of the highway.

When the man saw that all the people stood still, he carried Amasa out of the highway into the field, and cast a garment over him, when he saw that everyone who came by him stood still. 020:013 When he was removed out of the highway, all the people went on after Joab, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri. 020:014 He went through all the tribes of Israel to Abel, and to Beth Maacah, and all the Berites: and they were gathered together, and went also after him. 020:015

They came and besieged him in Abel of Beth Maacah, and they cast up a mound against the city, and it stood against the rampart; and all the people who were with Joab battered the wall, to throw it down. 020:016 Then cried a wise woman out of the city, "Hear, hear! Please say to Joab, 'Come near here, that I may speak with you.'" 020:017 He came near to her; and the woman said, Are you Joab? He answered, I am. Then she said to him, Hear the words of your handmaid. He answered, I do hear. 020:018 Then she spoke, saying, They were wont to speak in old time, saying, They shall surely ask [counsel] at Abel:

and so they ended [the matter].

020:019 I am of those who are peaceable and faithful in Israel: you seek to destroy a city and a mother in Israel: why will you swallow up the inheritance of Yahweh? 020:020 Joab answered, Far be it, far be it from me, that I should swallow up or destroy.

020:021 The matter is not so: but a man of the hill country of Ephraim, Sheba the son of Bichri by name, has lifted up his hand against the king, even against David; deliver him only, and I will depart from the city. The woman said to Joab, Behold, his head shall be thrown to you over the wall. 020:022 Then the

woman went to all the people in her wisdom. They cut off the head of Sheba the son of Bichri, and threw it out to Joab. He blew the trumpet, and they were dispersed from the city, every man to his tent. Joab returned to Jerusalem to the king.

020:023 Now Joab was over all the army of Israel; and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and over the Pelethites; 020:024 and Adoram was over the men subject to forced labor; and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was the recorder; 020:025 and Sheva was scribe; and Zadok and Abiathar were priests; 020:026 and also Ira the Jairite was chief

minister to David. 021:001 There was a famine in the days of David three years, year after year; and David sought the face of Yahweh. Yahweh said, It is for Saul, and for his bloody house, because he put to death the Gibeonites. 021:002 The king called the Gibeonites, and said to them (now the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, but of the remnant of the Amorites; and the children of Israel had sworn to them: and Saul sought to kill them in his zeal for the children of Israel and Judah); 021:003 and David said to the Gibeonites, What shall I do for you? And with what shall I make atonement, that you may

bless the inheritance of Yahweh?

**021:004 The Gibeonites said to him,
It is no matter of silver or gold
between us and Saul, or his house;
neither is it for us to put any man
to death in Israel. He said, What
you shall say, that will I do for you.**

**021:005 They said to the king, The
man who consumed us, and who
devised against us, [that] we should
be destroyed from remaining in any
of the borders of Israel, 021:006 let
seven men of his sons be delivered
to us, and we will hang them up to
Yahweh in Gibeah of Saul, the
chosen of Yahweh. The king said, I
will give them. 021:007 But the
king spared Mephibosheth, the son**

**of Jonathan the son of Saul,
because of Yahweh's oath that was
between them, between David and
Jonathan the son of Saul. 021:008
But the king took the two sons of
Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, whom
she bore to Saul, Armoni and
Mephibosheth; and the five sons of
Michal the daughter of Saul, whom
she bore to Adriel the son of
Barzillai the Meholathite: 021:009
He delivered them into the hands of
the Gibeonites, and they hanged
them in the mountain before
Yahweh, and they fell [all] seven
together. They were put to death in
the days of harvest, in the first
days, at the beginning of barley**

harvest. 021:010 Rizpah the daughter of Aiah took sackcloth, and spread it for her on the rock, from the beginning of harvest until water was poured on them from the sky; and she allowed neither the birds of the sky to rest on them by day, nor the animals of the field by night. 021:011 It was told David what Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, the concubine of Saul, had done. 021:012 David went and took the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men of Jabesh Gilead, who had stolen them from the street of Beth Shan, where the Philistines had hanged them, in the day that the Philistines

killed Saul in Gilboa; 021:013 and he brought up from there the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son: and they gathered the bones of those who were hanged. 021:014 They buried the bones of Saul and Jonathan his son in the country of Benjamin in Zela, in the tomb of Kish his father: and they performed all that the king commanded. After that God was entreated for the land. 021:015 The Philistines had war again with Israel; and David went down, and his servants with him, and fought against the Philistines. David grew faint; 021:016 and Ishbibenob, who was of the sons of the giant, the

weight of whose spear was three hundred [shekels] of brass in weight, he being girded with a new [sword], thought to have slain David. 021:017 But Abishai the son of Zeruiah helped him, and struck the Philistine, and killed him. Then the men of David swore to him, saying, You shall go no more out with us to battle, that you don't quench the lamp of Israel. 021:018 It came to pass after this, that there was again war with the Philistines at Gob: then Sibbecai the Hushathite killed Saph, who was of the sons of the giant. 021:019 There was again war with the Philistines at Gob; and Elhanan the son of

Jaareoregim the Bethlehemite killed Goliath the Gittite's brother, the staff of whose spear was like a weaver's beam. 021:020 There was again war at Gath, where was a man of great stature, who had on every hand six fingers, and on every foot six toes, four and twenty in number; and he also was born to the giant. 021:021 When he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimei, David's brother, killed him. 021:022 These four were born to the giant in Gath; and they fell by the hand of David, and by the hand of his servants. 022:001 David spoke to Yahweh the words of this song in the day that Yahweh

delivered him out of the hand of all his enemies, and out of the hand of Saul: 022:002 and he said, Yahweh is my rock, my fortress, and my deliverer, even mine; 022:003 God, my rock, in him I will take refuge; my shield, and the horn of my salvation, my high tower, and my refuge. My savior, you save me from violence. 022:004 I will call on Yahweh, who is worthy to be praised: So shall I be saved from my enemies. 022:005 For the waves of death surrounded me. The floods of ungodliness made me afraid. 022:006 The cords of Sheol were around me. The snares of death caught me. 022:007 In my distress I

**called on Yahweh. Yes, I called to
my God. He heard my voice out of
his temple. My cry [came] into his
ears. 022:008 Then the earth shook
and trembled. The foundations of
heaven quaked and were shaken,
because he was angry. 022:009
Smoke went up out of his nostrils.
Fire out of his mouth devoured.
Coals were kindled by it. 022:010
He bowed the heavens also, and
came down. Thick darkness was
under his feet. 022:011 He rode on
a cherub, and flew. Yes, he was seen
on the wings of the wind. 022:012
He made darkness pavilions
around himself: gathering of
waters, and thick clouds of the**

**skies. 022:013 At the brightness
before him, coals of fire were
kindled. 022:014 Yahweh
thundered from heaven. The Most
High uttered his voice. 022:015 He
sent out arrows, and scattered
them; lightning, and confused
them. 022:016 Then the channels of
the sea appeared. The foundations
of the world were laid bare by the
rebuke of Yahweh, At the blast of
the breath of his nostrils. 022:017
He sent from on high and he took
me. He drew me out of many
waters. 022:018 He delivered me
from my strong enemy, from those
who hated me, for they were too
mighty for me. 022:019 They came**

**on me in the day of my calamity,
but Yahweh was my support.**

**022:020 He also brought me out
into a large place. He delivered me,
because he delighted in me. 022:021**

**Yahweh rewarded me according to
my righteousness. He rewarded me
according to the cleanness of my
hands. 022:022 For I have kept the
ways of Yahweh, and have not
wickedly departed from my God.**

**022:023 For all his ordinances were
before me. As for his statutes, I did
not depart from them. 022:024 I**

**was also perfect toward him. I kept
myself from my iniquity. 022:025**

**Therefore Yahweh has rewarded
me according to my righteousness,**

**According to my cleanness in his
eyesight. 022:026 With the merciful
you will show yourself merciful.
With the perfect man you will show
yourself perfect. 022:027 With the
pure you will show yourself pure.
With the crooked you will show
yourself shrewd. 022:028 You will
save the afflicted people, But your
eyes are on the haughty, that you
may bring them down. 022:029 For
you are my lamp, Yahweh. Yahweh
will light up my darkness. 022:030
For by you, I run against a troop.
By my God, I leap over a wall.
022:031 As for God, his way is
perfect. The word of Yahweh is
tested. He is a shield to all those**

**who take refuge in him. 022:032
For who is God, besides Yahweh?
Who is a rock, besides our God?
022:033 God is my strong fortress.
He makes my way perfect. 022:034
He makes his feet like hinds' [feet],
and sets me on my high places.
022:035 He teaches my hands to
war, so that my arms bend a bow of
brass. 022:036 You have also given
me the shield of your salvation.
Your gentleness has made me great.
022:037 You have enlarged my
steps under me. My feet have not
slipped. 022:038 I have pursued my
enemies and destroyed them. I
didn't turn again until they were
consumed. 022:039 I have**

consumed them, and struck them through, so that they can't arise.

Yes, they have fallen under my feet.

022:040 For you have armed me with strength for the battle. You have subdued under me those who rose up against me. 022:041 You have also made my enemies turn their backs to me, that I might cut off those who hate me. 022:042

They looked, but there was none to save; even to Yahweh, but he didn't answer them. 022:043 Then I beat them as small as the dust of the earth. I crushed them as the mire of the streets, and spread them abroad. 022:044 You also have delivered me from the strivings of

**my people. You have kept me to be
the head of the nations. A people
whom I have not known will serve
me. 022:045 The foreigners will
submit themselves to me. As soon
as they hear of me, they will obey
me. 022:046 The foreigners will
fade away, and will come trembling
out of their close places. 022:047
Yahweh lives! Blessed be my rock!
Exalted be God, the rock of my
salvation, 022:048 even the God
who executes vengeance for me,
who brings down peoples under
me, 022:049 who brings me away
from my enemies. Yes, you lift me
up above those who rise up against
me. You deliver me from the violent**

man. 022:050 Therefore I will give thanks to you, Yahweh, among the nations. Will sing praises to your name. 022:051 He gives great deliverance to his king, and shows loving kindness to his anointed, to David and to his seed, forevermore. 023:001 Now these are the last words of David. David the son of Jesse says, the man who was raised on high says, the anointed of the God of Jacob, the sweet psalmist of Israel: 023:002 The Spirit of Yahweh spoke by me. His word was on my tongue. 023:003 The God of Israel said, the Rock of Israel spoke to me, one who rules over men righteously, who rules in the fear of

**God, 023:004 [He shall be] as the
light of the morning, when the sun
rises, a morning without clouds,
[When] the tender grass [springs]
out of the earth, Through clear
shining after rain. 023:005 Most
certainly my house is not so with
God, yet he has made with me an
everlasting covenant, ordered in all
things, and sure, for it is all my
salvation, and all [my] desire,
although he doesn't make it grow.
023:006 But all of the ungodly shall
be as thorns to be thrust away,
because they can't be taken with
the hand, 023:007 But the man who
touches them must be armed with
iron and the staff of a spear. They**

shall be utterly burned with fire in [their] place. 023:008 These are the names of the mighty men whom David had: Josheb Basshebeth a Tahchemonite, chief of the captains; the same was Adino the Eznite, against eight hundred slain at one time. 023:009 After him was Eleazar the son of Dodai the son of an Ahohite, one of the three mighty men with David, when they defied the Philistines who were there gathered together to battle, and the men of Israel were gone away. 023:010 He arose, and struck the Philistines until his hand was weary, and his hand froze to the sword; and Yahweh worked a great

victory that day; and the people returned after him only to take spoil. 023:011 After him was Shammah the son of Agee a Hararite. The Philistines were gathered together into a troop, where was a plot of ground full of lentils; and the people fled from the Philistines. 023:012 But he stood in the midst of the plot, and defended it, and killed the Philistines; and Yahweh worked a great victory. 023:013 Three of the thirty chief men went down, and came to David in the harvest time to the cave of Adullam; and the troop of the Philistines was encamped in the valley of Rephaim. 023:014 David

was then in the stronghold; and the garrison of the Philistines was then in Bethlehem. 023:015 David longed, and said, Oh that one would give me water to drink of the well of Bethlehem, which is by the gate! 023:016 The three mighty men broke through the army of the Philistines, and drew water out of the well of Bethlehem, that was by the gate, and took it, and brought it to David: but he would not drink of it, but poured it out to Yahweh.

023:017 He said, Be it far from me, Yahweh, that I should do this: [shall I drink] the blood of the men who went in jeopardy of their lives? therefore he would not drink it.

These things did the three mighty men. 023:018 Abishai, the brother of Joab, the son of Zeruiah, was chief of the three. He lifted up his spear against three hundred and killed them, and had a name among the three. 023:019 Wasn't he most honorable of the three? therefore he was made their captain: however he didn't attain to the [first] three. 023:020 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant man of Kabzeel, who had done mighty deeds, he killed the two [sons of] Ariel of Moab: he went down also and killed a lion in the midst of a pit in time of snow. 023:021 He killed an Egyptian, a

goodly man: and the Egyptian had a spear in his hand; but he went down to him with a staff, and plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's hand, and killed him with his own spear. 023:022 These things did Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and had a name among the three mighty men. 023:023 He was more honorable than the thirty, but he didn't attain to the [first] three. David set him over his guard. 023:024 Asahel the brother of Joab was one of the thirty; Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem, 023:025 Shammah the Harodite, Elikah the Harodite, 023:026 Helez the Paltite, Ira the

**son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, 023:027
Abiezer the Anathothite, Mebunnai
the Hushathite, 023:028 Zalmon
the Ahohite, Maharai the
Netophathite, 023:029 Heleb the
son of Baanah the Netophathite,
Ittai the son of Ribai of Gibeah of
the children of Benjamin, 023:030
Benaiah a Pirathonite, Hiddai of
the brooks of Gaash. 023:031
Abialbon the Arbathite, Azmaveth
the Barhumite, 023:032 Eliahba the
Shaalbonite, the sons of Jashen,
Jonathan, 023:033 Shammah the
Hararite, Ahiam the son of Sharar
the Ararite, 023:034 Eliphelet the
son of Ahasbai, the son of the
Maacathite, Eliam the son of**

**Ahithophel the Gilonite, 023:035
Hezro the Carmelite, Paarai the
Arbite, 023:036 Igal the son of
Nathan of Zobah, Bani the Gadite,
023:037 Zelek the Ammonite,
Naharai the Beerothite, armor
bearers to Joab the son of Zeruiah,
023:038 Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the
Ithrite, 023:039 Uriah the Hittite:
thirty-seven in all. 024:001 Again
the anger of Yahweh was kindled
against Israel, and he moved David
against them, saying, Go, number
Israel and Judah. 024:002 The king
said to Joab the captain of the
army, who was with him, Go now
back and forth through all the
tribes of Israel, from Dan even to**

Beersheba, and number you the people, that I may know the sum of the people. 024:003 Joab said to the king, Now Yahweh your God add to the people, however many they may be, one hundred times; and may the eyes of my lord the king see it: but why does my lord the king delight in this thing? 024:004

Notwithstanding, the king's word prevailed against Joab, and against the captains of the army. Joab and the captains of the army went out from the presence of the king, to number the people of Israel.

024:005 They passed over the Jordan, and encamped in Aroer, on the right side of the city that is in

**the middle of the valley of Gad, and
to Jazer: 024:006 then they came to
Gilead, and to the land of Tahtim
Hodshi; and they came to Dan
Jaan, and round about to Sidon,
024:007 and came to the stronghold
of Tyre, and to all the cities of the
Hivites, and of the Canaanites; and
they went out to the south of
Judah, at Beersheba. 024:008 So
when they had gone back and forth
through all the land, they came to
Jerusalem at the end of nine
months and twenty days. 024:009
Joab gave up the sum of the
numbering of the people to the
king: and there were in Israel eight
hundred thousand valiant men who**

drew the sword; and the men of Judah were five hundred thousand men. 024:010 David's heart struck him after that he had numbered the people. David said to Yahweh, I have sinned greatly in that which I have done: but now, Yahweh, put away, I beg you, the iniquity of your servant; for I have done very foolishly. 024:011 When David rose up in the morning, the word of Yahweh came to the prophet Gad, David's seer, saying, 024:012 Go and speak to David, Thus says Yahweh, I offer you three things: choose you one of them, that I may do it to you. 024:013 So Gad came to David, and told him, and said to

him, Shall seven years of famine come to you in your land? or will you flee three months before your foes while they pursue you? or shall there be three days' pestilence in your land? now advise you, and consider what answer I shall return to him who sent me. 024:014 David said to Gad, I am in a great strait: let us fall now into the hand of Yahweh; for his mercies are great; and let me not fall into the hand of man. 024:015 So Yahweh sent a pestilence on Israel from the morning even to the time appointed; and there died of the people from Dan even to Beersheba seventy thousand men. 024:016

When the angel stretched out his hand toward Jerusalem to destroy it, Yahweh repented him of the evil, and said to the angel who destroyed the people, It is enough; now stay your hand. The angel of Yahweh was by the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite. 024:017

David spoke to Yahweh when he saw the angel who struck the people, and said, Behold, I have sinned, and I have done perversely; but these sheep, what have they done? Please let your hand be against me, and against my father's house. 024:018 Gad came that day to David, and said to him, Go up, rear an altar to Yahweh in the

**threshing floor of Araunah the
Jebusite. 024:019 David went up
according to the saying of Gad, as
Yahweh commanded. 024:020
Araunah looked forth, and saw the
king and his servants coming on
toward him: and Araunah went
out, and bowed himself before the
king with his face to the ground.
024:021 Araunah said, Why is my
lord the king come to his servant?
David said, To buy the threshing
floor of you, to build an altar to
Yahweh, that the plague may be
stayed from the people. 024:022
Araunah said to David, Let my lord
the king take and offer up what
seems good to him: behold, the**

oxen for the burnt offering, and the threshing instruments and the yokes of the oxen for the wood: 024:023 all this, king, does Araunah give to the king. Araunah said to the king, Yahweh your God accept you. 024:024 The king said to Araunah, No; but I will most certainly buy it of you at a price. Neither will I offer burnt offerings to Yahweh my God which cost me nothing. So David bought the threshing floor and the oxen for fifty shekels of silver. 024:025 David built there an altar to Yahweh, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. So Yahweh was entreated for the land,

**and the plague was stayed from
Israel.**

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